

Κλαύδιος Πτολεμαῖος

Ptolemy of Alexandria on Astronomy, Geography, and Harmonics

eul_aid: phs

Period: Ῥωμαϊκή [Roman](#)
Dialect: Κοινή τεχνική [Technical Koine](#)
Domain: Μαθηματικά [Mathematics](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)

Claudius Ptolemy was a Greco-Roman mathematician, astronomer, geographer, and astrologer active in Alexandria during the 2nd century CE. His recorded astronomical observations date from 127 to 141 CE, placing his career under the reign of Antoninus Pius. Ptolemy synthesized earlier Greek, Babylonian, and possibly Egyptian knowledge, most notably building upon the astronomical models of Hipparchus.

Though details of his personal life are scarce, his prolific output indicates he worked within Alexandria's scholarly community, dedicating some works to a figure named Syrus. Ptolemy's major surviving works in Greek include the *Almagest*, a comprehensive astronomical treatise; the *Geography*; the astrological *Tetrabiblos*; the *Harmonics*; the *Optics*; and several specialized texts like *On the Analemma* and the *Planetary Hypotheses*.

His significance lies in his systematic compilation and mathematical refinement of ancient science, which remained authoritative for over a millennium. The geocentric model in the *Almagest* dominated astronomy until Copernicus, while his *Geography* fundamentally shaped medieval and Renaissance cartography.

Works (13)

- Φαινόμενα · [Appearances](#) · 65 passages
- Προχείρων κανόνων διάταξις καὶ ψηφοφορία · [Arrangement and Voting of Handy Rules](#) · 25 passages
- Γεωγραφία Βιβλία Α'-Γ' · [Geography Books 1-3](#) · 245 passages
- Γεωγραφία Βιβλία Δ'-Η' · [Geography Books 4-8](#) · 1052 passages
- Ἀρμονικά · [Harmonics](#) · 96 passages
- Ὑποθέσεις · [Hypotheses](#) · 18 passages
- Ἐπιγραφή τοῦ Κανώπου · [Inscription of Canopus](#) · 7 passages
- Μαθηματικὴ Σύνταξις · [Mathematical Composition](#) · 1005 passages
- Μουσική · [Music](#) · 23 passages
- Ἀποσπάσματα · [On Inclinations](#) · 9 passages
- Περὶ τοῦ Ἀναλήμματος · [On the Analemma](#) · 19 passages
- Περὶ τῆς κριτικῆς δυνάμεως καὶ τῆς ψυχῆς ἡγεμονίας · [On the Faculty of Judgment and Sovereignty of the Soul](#) · 20 passages
- Τετράβιβλος · [Tetrabiblos](#) · 63 passages